

ANTONIO MUSTO

antoniomusto.com

amusto@gmail.com

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Early Islam

Joint Religious Studies and Asian and Middle Eastern Studies
University of Minnesota – Twin Cities, Minneapolis, MN

Postdoctoral Teaching Fellow, Core Curriculum, 2024-2025

New York University, New York, NY

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Middle Eastern and Islamic Studies, 2024

New York University, New York, NY

Dissertation: “Between Bukhārā and Baghdād: New Histories for Sufism’s Formative Period”

Committee: Everett Rowson (chair), Marion Katz, Ismail Alatas, Robert Hoyland (reader),

Martin Nguyen (reader)

Master of Philosophy, Middle Eastern and Islamic Studies, 2021

New York University, New York, NY

Master of Arts, The Study of Religion, 2014

The University of Chicago, Divinity School

Bachelor of Arts, Religious Studies, 2011

Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Musto, Antonio. “A New Text for the History of Sufism: Abū Manṣūr al-Iṣfahānī’s (d. 418/1027) *Shawāhid al-Taṣawwuf*,” *Journal of Sufi Studies*, Winter 2025.

Musto, Antonio. “From Trial (*Miḥna*) to Tribulation (*Balā*): A New Look at Ghulām Khalīl’s (d. 275/888) Inquisition Against the Sufis,” *al-‘Uṣūr al-Wuṣṭā* 32 (2024):22-50, 2024.

ARTICLES UNDER REVIEW

Musto, Antonio. “An Early Argument for One God: Two Excerpts from al-Ḥārith b. Asad al-Muḥāsibī’s (d. 243/857) *Kitāb al-‘Aẓama* and *al-Tanbīh ‘alā A‘māl al-Qulūb*,” *Journal of Islamic Studies*

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

“Towards Creating an Islamicate Digital Toolkit: Assessing the Landscape and Charting a Path Forward,” at the *Digital Hadith Workshop*, held at the Berlin Institute for Islamic Theology, at Humboldt University of Berlin, May 2025

“An Early Argument for One God: al-Muḥāsibī’s (d. 243/857) Kitāb al-‘Azama,” at the *Theology in Arabic Seminars*, at Georgetown University, February 2025

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Expanding Networks: Prosopography, Digital Tools, and New Histories of Sufism’s Formative Period (3rd/9th-6th/12th c.),” presented at the *2025 Middle East Studies Association Annual Meeting*

“Re-thinking Hagiography: Familial Legacy, Saintly Authority, and Everyday Life in the Karāmāt Abī ‘Alī al-Qūmsānī,” presented at the *2025 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*

“Gazing at Youth, Anal Sex (*liwāt*), and Sufis: Reassessing the Historiographical Landscape of Early Sufism,” presented at the *2024 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*

“The Author Formerly Known as Ibn Yazdānyār (d. 472/1079): A New Look at the *Rawḍat al-Murīdīn* and Its Place in the Broader Sufi Tradition,” presented at the *2023 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*.

“The Many Faces of a Miḥna: Ghulām Khalīl’s (d. 275/888) Anti-Sufi Trial,” presented at the *2022 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*.

“Between Censure and Praise: Biographical Dictionaries and the View of Monks in Early Islam” presented via Zoom at Cambridge University’s *The Late Antique and Medieval Social Network: A Round Table*.

“Šūfī Arba‘īnāt: The Role of Ḥadīth in the Codification and Normalization of Šūfī Beliefs and Practices during the 4th/10th and 5th/11th Centuries,” selected to be presented at the cancelled *2020 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*.

“Those Who Wear Wool: A Look at *al-Šufiyya* and *al-Mutaṣawwifa* before the Emergence of Sufism,” presented at the *2019 American Oriental Society Annual Meeting*.

“A Tale of Two “Mystics”: Exploring the Relationship Between Ḥājī Baktāsh Valī and Jalāl al-Dīn Rūmī,” presented at the *University of Chicago Middle Eastern History and Theory Conference*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

“al-Andalus,” University of Minnesota, Spring 2026.

“Sufism: From Mystical Love to Anti-Colonial Resistance,” University of Minnesota, Fall 2025.

“An Intellectual Odyssey with Islam’s Holy Scripture,” University of Minnesota, Fall 2025.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

OpenAI's Researcher Access Program, OpenAI, 2025

Carola Collier Berthelot Trust Fellowship, New York University, 2023-24

Digital Humanities Seed Grant, Principal Investigator, New York University, 2023-24

Collaborative International Research Grant, American Academy of Religion, 2023

Graduate Student Digital Humanities Fellowship, New York University, 2022

Syriac Digital Humanities Fellowship, Beth Mardutho Institute, 2022

NYU Global Research Initiative Fellowship, NYU Berlin, 2021

Dumbarton Oaks/HMML Syriac Summer School Fellowship, St. John's University, 2019

Center for Arabic Study Abroad Fellowship, American University, Cairo, Egypt, 2017-18

Critical Language Scholarship for Persian, US State Department, Tajikistan, 2014

Divinity School Scholarship, University of Chicago 2012-14

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and Coordinator, "The Premodern Islamic World Lecture Series," New York University. 2022-2024. Responsible for organizing, inviting speakers for, and running a monthly lecture series.

Research Assistant for Professor Alatas, New York University, 2020-2022. Assisted in research, Arabic translation, and editing.

Co-Founder and Coordinator, "*Dardasha*," New York University, 2018-2020. Organized and secured funding for a weekly Arabic discussion for students of all levels that was then institutionalized by department.

Co-Founder and Coordinator, "*Guftogu*," New York University, 2018-2019. Organized and secured funding for a weekly Persian Discussion for students of all levels.

Co-Founder and Coordinator, "Monthly Arabic Lecture Series," New York University, 2018-2020. Organized and secured funding for a monthly lecture given in Arabic by various artists and intellectuals from New York Cities Arabic-speaking communities.

SERVICE

De Gruyter Brill's Digital Scholarship Advisory Board Member, 2026-Present

RELS Curriculum Revision Committee Member, University of Minnesota, 2026-Present

Webmaster for Middle East Medievalists, 2025-Present

RELS Steering Committee Member, University of Minnesota, 2025-Present

RELS Islamic Studies Committee Member, University of Minnesota, 2025-Present

Founder and Developer, Kashshāf: A Corpus Creation and Management Tool
(www.kashshaf.com)

Founder and Developer, Nuṣūṣ: A Corpus of Digitally Neglected Texts (www.nusus.net)

Graduate Student Liaison, The American Oriental Society, 2020-2023

LANGUAGES

Arabic	(Near-Native Reading and Writing; High Advanced Speaking)
Persian	(Reading with Dictionary; Intermediate Writing and Speaking)
Syriac	(Reading with Dictionary)
Italian	(Reading with Dictionary)
French	(Reading with Dictionary)

RELEVANT SKILLS

Working Knowledge of: Python, HTML, CSS, React, and SQL